

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Electricity shortages, higher bills on horizon

AI boom may cause problems in state in only 5 years, report says

By John Lippert
Chicago Tribune

With artificial intelligence sparking a surge in electricity demand, Illinois could be only five years away from chronic shortages and higher monthly bills, according to a report released late Monday by three state agencies.

Illinois must act immediately to plug this looming gap, according to the report, since the new electricity sources the state will need typically take five to seven years to build.

Independent analysts have long warned of potential shortages as data centers and other big electricity users mushroom, especially in northeast Illinois, and as the state prepares to close dozens of coal- and natural gas-fired power plants to clean the air.

The 222-page report, however, marks the first time the state has formally adopted such a dire tone. It sets the stage for Springfield regulators to play a more hands-on role in potentially delaying the scheduled power plant closures and raising electricity rates to build more renewable and fossil-fuel capacity.

As things stand now, the report said, neither the Commonwealth Edison service territory of northern Illinois, nor the Ameren area downstate, “has sufficient ... resources to reliably meet 2030 requirements under several potential scenarios.”

In the report, the Illinois Commerce Commission, the Illinois Environmental Protection Agency and the Illinois Power Agency outlined a series of steps the state can take to mitigate the crisis.

These include expanding renewable power generation, transmission lines, and battery storage, promoting greater energy conservation, and potentially

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U.S. Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino walks with agents after detaining a person while conducting an immigration enforcement operation in Little Village on Tuesday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Bovino, agents return in show of force across area

At least 100 from Homeland Security make seemingly made-for-TV jaunt across Chicago, suburbs

By Tess Kenny,
Laura Rodríguez Presa,
Caroline Kubzansky
and Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino and dozens of federal immigration agents returned in force across Chicago and the suburbs Tuesday for a seemingly made-for-television jaunt about a month after he and scores of Border Patrol agents left town.

At least 100 U.S. Homeland Security agents or officers were in the Chicago area for the latest

wave of federal immigration enforcement activity, according to a federal source familiar with the effort.

The agents made several arrests in supermarket parking lots and tamale stands — detaining a man who has lived in the U.S. for about 20 years and was described as hardworking and humble by his daughter — while goading angry residents who confronted them and threatening to unleash tear gas.

The tense and chaotic confrontations on the Southwest Side and west suburbs began almost

immediately after videos showing uniformed, masked men driving unmarked vehicles circulated online Tuesday morning.

At 10:30 a.m., a crowd had formed in Little Village where agents detained a man at 27th Street and Ridgeway Avenue. Residents screamed, blew whistles and filmed as the agents put the man in their vehicle. Bystanders clustered up and down the street on shop corners.

One agent stood on the rim of his car door. As the agent yelled at the people, two cans of tear gas fell out of the federal agent’s vehi-

cle, though they didn’t deploy. Another agent dangled a full size tear gas canister out the window a few blocks away before the officers drove north. Agents also carried pepper ball guns.

Bovino, wearing a green parka over his fatigues and holding a gun to his chest, told a group of reporters and angry neighbors on a street corner that “we never left.” He ignored a man who asked him for a “rational conversation.”

“All right guys. Merry Christ-

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The family of slain Chicago police Officer Andrés Maurício Vázquez Lasso, including his widow Milena Estepa de Vázquez, left, and mother, Rocío Lasso, second from right, walk through the hallway at the Leighton Criminal Court Building on Tuesday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Man sentenced to life in prison in slaying of Chicago police officer

However, recent legislation offers a chance at parole

By Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

In his niece’s drawings, Chicago police Officer Andrés Vázquez Lasso now rests inside a cloud.

It’s been difficult for the 7-year-old to fully comprehend

that her uncle is gone, no longer available to get ice cream with her or play with her, the 32-year-old officer’s mother said.

In a tearful statement, Rocío Lasso described her family’s sudden loss on March 1, 2023, when Vázquez Lasso was gunned down while responding to a 911 call.

After several hours of arguments and testimony, Cook County Judge John Lyke ordered a sentence of life in

prison for Steven Montano, 21, after a jury in July convicted him of first-degree murder following a weeklong trial that showcased body camera footage of the slaying and emotional testimony from his wife and other responding police officers.

“Part of me died with him,” his mother said, wiping away tears.

Despite the natural life sentence, though, new legisla-

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Pritzker signs transit bill that should avert big cuts

Governor cautions that ‘transformation takes a little bit of time’

By Talia Soglin
and Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker on Tuesday celebrated his enactment of a new law that advocates say will avert catastrophic service cuts on Chicago’s public transit systems and make the region’s trains and buses safer and more reliable — even as he acknowledged “transformation takes a little bit of time.”

“Far from heading toward the abyss, as some predicted, we are on the verge of delivering a world-class transportation network,” Pritzker said, flanked by dozens of transit officials, advocates, legislators and labor leaders in Union

Station.

The legislation signed Tuesday, which state lawmakers approved in October after months of negotiations and several failed legislative attempts, will provide about \$1.5 billion annually for regional transportation from a diversion of the motor fuel sales tax, an increase to a sales tax in the Chicago region and interest from the state’s road fund. The new law also raises tolls on the Illinois Tollway by 45 cents.

The new funding is intended to avert a major fiscal crisis that loomed over the CTA, Metra and Pace — and provide enough extra money for the transit agencies to make significant improvements to service, advocates say.

Pritzker said riders can expect funding increases, and eventually, a “world-class system.” But that

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INSIDE

Program provides a fair shot at success

Inspiration Kitchens’ free culinary boot camp in Chicago helps students break barriers to find jobs in food service. **Food & Health**



Students stir ingredients as they make a component of an apple cake at Inspiration Kitchens. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

TRADE WINDS PICKING UP? Is it time for the Bulls to move Coby White? Is there still a market for Nikola Vučević? **Chicago Sports**

